

“MNCs bring in a great deal of experience to connectors market and use this to their advantage by quickly adapting to the local requirements. Also, it is easy to adapt rather than re-inventing the wheel —Rajaram Srinivas, marketing manager, Molex (India)



emerge as a potentially large market for AV and PCB connectors in the next few years.

Emerging opportunities

“Transport market will be one of the most attractive markets in India for at least next five years due to ongoing metro train projects in the country. At the same time, there is a huge emphasis on modernisation of the existing trains and signaling system. Most global players are already aware of this and fighting for their share in the market. Companies are looking at local production facilities to retain their competitive edge. But again, we expect that only those productions will be transferred to India where manual labour related work is involved, so as to bring down the cost,” says Rao.

In addition, “Energy and power has a huge potential in India and looks promising for next ten years,” according to Nirmal Kumar Saraf, head-accessories, Lapp India.

Manufacturing in India

“Most electronic connectors require a very sophisticated level of manufacturing, complete with moulding/stamping and plating facility. There are very few companies in India that have the capability to manufacture these connectors in India. These companies always had the export market in mind and not the local market due to the economy of scale. Most of the manufacturers abroad have huge global production facilities that use fully automated machines. The sheer volumes bring their overall cost down,” says Rao.

It is estimated that there are about 40 connector manufacturing units

operating in India, with 70 per cent of them classified under small-scale industry. The major share of the Indian market is contributed by five companies, namely, Amphenol Interconnect India, FCI OEN Connectors, TEI Technologies, Tyco Electronics Corporation India and Molex India—according to ELCOMOS report by ELCINA.

Other key manufacturers include Allied Electronics, Bright Star Component, Delphi, Essen Deinki, Gilard Electronics, Lapp India, Phoenix Contact (India), Protection Electromech, TE Connectivity and Wago & Controls (India).

Harting Technology Group, headquartered in Germany, operates in India through its subsidiary Harting India, which has sales offices in Bengaluru, Mumbai and Gurgaon. Other global players who have sales offices in India include USA-based Samtec and Taiwan-based Toyo Connectors & Cables.

Among all types of connectors, RF connectors, PCB connectors, signal connectors and power connectors fare badly in terms of local manufacturing in India—going by ELCOMOS report by ELCINA. For these connectors, imports are to the tune of 60 per cent or more (as much as 72 per cent in case of power connectors). On the other hand, imports are 40 per cent for AV connectors and only 23 per cent for MIL connectors.

Saraf explains, “In RF connectors, PCB connectors and signal connectors, the quality of pins/contact part is very important to receive the signals. Also, in instrumentation, the cost of these connectors is treated as C-class, so customers do not want to take



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